

Network Operations Incident Management Policy

1. Incident Classification

All network incidents must be classified by severity within 15 minutes of detection. Critical incidents affect core routing, broadband backhaul, or mobile authentication. High incidents involve regional service degradation with potential customer impact. Medium incidents are localized and usually affect a single node or access segment. Low incidents are informational and should be monitored until resolution.

2. Restoration Targets

Critical outages require restoration work to begin immediately and service restoration should be completed within 4 hours whenever possible. High severity incidents must be restored within 8 hours. Medium severity incidents should be resolved within 24 hours. Low severity incidents can remain under observation, but every case must have an assigned owner and a documented update at least once per business day.

3. Escalation Rules

If a Major Service Outage affects more than 2,500 customers or spans more than one region, the case must be escalated to the Network Operations Director. Escalation must occur within 30 minutes of confirmation. The incident bridge must remain open until service has stabilized and no new alarms are observed for 20 consecutive minutes.

4. Communication Cadence

Customer communications must be issued every 60 minutes for unresolved Critical incidents and every 2 hours for High incidents. Internal leadership updates are required at the top of each hour during active incidents. Status messages must include impacted services, estimated restoration time, and the next update time. All timestamps must be recorded in the incident log.

5. Root Cause Review

Every outage longer than 6 hours requires a root cause review within 5 business days. The review must identify the triggering event, the failing component, and any missed preventive control. Corrective actions must include a due date, an owner, and a validation step. Repeat incidents on the same network element require a second review by engineering.

6. Closure Criteria

An outage may be closed only after service verification, customer impact assessment, and documentation of the final fix. The incident record must include the restored timestamp, the final status, and a summary of monitoring performed after restoration. If alarms recur within 24 hours, the outage must be reopened and linked to the original record.

7. Monitoring Standards

Network monitoring teams must review core performance dashboards every 15 minutes. Packet loss above 2 percent, latency above 120 milliseconds, or repeated authentication failures must be treated as actionable

signals. When these thresholds are observed, the operations analyst must create or update an incident ticket and notify the on-call engineer immediately.